

How can politicians, boards and CEOs use DoView strategy/outcomes diagrams to ensure effective governance and high-level management?

There is a group of people who are charged with the oversight of organizations, agencies, providers, policies or initiatives. These include politicians with ministerial responsibility, governance boards, CEOs, and, others in governance or high-level management positions. They also include other people with monitoring or oversight roles at various levels, such as, in the case of government, central agency analysts.

All of these people face a common challenge - they need some way of overviewing what an organization or initiative is doing. In the case of those in governance and high-level management positions, they need to provide prioritization and strategic direction at the appropriate level. They need to be assured that the organization or initiative is not distracted from its strategic mission and neglecting any important areas of work. They should be able to quickly establish that indicators and Key Performance Indicators KPIs measure the important aspects of the organization or initiative's work. They also need to have some way of making sure that the activities of the organization or initiative are tightly aligned to its priorities. Lastly, they need to be able to overview what evaluation activity is taking place within the organization to provide the type of strategic information needed for future decision-making.

Due to other responsibilities, people in such oversight roles usually only have a short amount of time to ensure that all of the above is being done. Presently they have to rely on the relevant organizations or initiatives providing them with information in a range of formats describing the organization or initiative's work. They will be given presentations and written reports and have verbal discussions outlining what is being done. These may or may not be in the optimal form for rapidly providing an overview of the work of the organization or initiative. In contrast to the standard format for financial information that is dictated by accounting standards, there are currently no universally adopted frameworks for presenting the strategic information listed above. The use of DoView Planning, including the use of DoView strategy/outcomes diagrams provides such a standardized format. If decision-makers familiarized themselves with the approach and required that organizations or initiatives adopt it, they would find that they had a significantly faster and more effective way of exercising oversight of the organizations and initiatives they are responsible for.